

Date: May 7, 2026

**Independent Methodology Review Statement
RIK Athletica — Protocol Engine (v3.1)**

I, Emily Norman, MS, RDN (CDR #86117608), conducted an independent review of the RIK Athletica Protocol Engine (version 3.1) and its supporting materials.

Scope of Review

My evaluation covered RIK Athletica's carbohydrate targets, sodium and hydration ranges, gut-adaptation protocols, caffeine and recovery timing, and race-week tapering rules. This included an 8-page methodology summary, inline evidence-based citations, and sample athlete deliverables demonstrating the engine's practical application.

Findings & Conclusions

Based on my review, the RIK Athletica methodology is consistent with established evidence-based sports nutrition principles for endurance training and competition.

- **Carbohydrate Strategy:** Targets utilize multiple transportable carbohydrate ratios to support CHO absorption and sustain endurance performance.
- **Gut Training:** The progressive gut-adaptation approach is clinically sound for improving GI tolerance during prolonged exercise.
- **Hydration:** Hydration and sodium strategies are appropriate and reflect commonly used evidence-based frameworks in endurance settings.
- **Recovery:** The structured recovery approach, including the placement of recovery compounds and post-session protein support, reflects a thoughtful and practical framework for supporting training adaptation and recovery needs.
- **Race-Week Tapering:** Guidance is well-founded, prioritizing protocol stability, GI risk mitigation, and avoidance of last-minute nutritional changes before competition.

Overall, the system demonstrates a clear, well-structured translation of sports nutrition guidance into applied fueling protocols, greatly suited for endurance athletes. As with all performance nutrition strategies, individual variability in tolerance, physiological response, and environmental conditions should be considered during implementation.

Scope Clarification

This review reflects a methodology-level assessment and does not constitute medical advice, individualized nutrition counseling, or a guarantee of performance. Athletes with pre-existing medical conditions or chronic GI disorders should consult a qualified healthcare professional before beginning any high-intensity nutrition protocol.

Signed,

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